

SPACE TRAVEL

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WHEREAS WINGED FLIGHT WAS DEVELOPED mostly through the efforts of individual enthusiasts, inventors and entrepreneurs, the exploration of space demanded the resources that only large nations could command. The basics of flight into space were simple enough. Given a sufficiently powerful thrust, any object could theoretically be flung either into orbit or beyond the pull of the Earth's gravity. But in practice such a venture posed daunting problems – requiring rockets with awesome power, space vehicles capable of withstanding extreme forces and temperatures, communication and control systems of great precision, and support systems to sustain life outside the atmosphere. That space travel has become a reality is a supreme example of organization and technological innovation, as well as of individual human courage.



HEADING FOR THE MOON

The Apollo 11 mission blasts off for the Moon on July 16, 1969. The manned Moon landing was the fulfillment of a dream that had long inspired rocket and science fiction enthusiasts, but that hardheaded practical people had mostly dismissed as mere fantasy.